

module-05-dot-addition - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - primary band

Module 5 — Bindu Paddhati — Dot Addition (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Bindu Paddhati* · **Band:** Primary (3-5) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

A 20th-century mental-arithmetic technique for column addition.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 5's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

Write $8 + 7$ on the board. Solve traditionally. Now do it with dots: 8 dots ●●●●●●●● + 7 dots ●●●●●●● = 15 dots ●●●●●●●●●●●●●●. “That’s the idea. Today we use this trick for much bigger sums.”

Core idea · 15 min

The dot method: when you add and get 10 or more, put a DOT next to the number above.

Example: $6 + 7$ in a column. $6 \ 7 \rightarrow 6 + 7 = 13$. Write 3, put a DOT.

Each dot = 10. So at the end: count dots $\times 10$, add the remainder.

Practice: $8 + 9$ in a column.

Demonstration · 10 min

On the board, do $7 + 8$ with the dot. Then $9 + 6$. Then $8 + 4 + 5$. Children call out the dots together. Cheer for each correct answer.

Source moment · 5 min

Story of an Indian teacher in the 1960s who saw children struggling with long column addition and said: “*What if we used a dot to mean ten?*” The trick spread to schools all over India.

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Practice worksheet: 8 column-addition problems using the dot method. Pairs check each other.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

Each child shows one problem they solved with the dot method. Round of applause.

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — Why mental arithmetic? The setup
- **Day 02** — Single-digit + single-digit with the dot
- **Day 03** — Two-digit column addition
- **Day 04** — Three- and four-digit columns
- **Day 05** — Speed practice — Bindu Paddhati vs traditional
- **Day 06** — Why it works — place value + carry
- **Day 07** — Honest history — Tirthaji 1965, Dani 1993 critique
- **Day 08** — Bridge to computer arithmetic — carry-save addition
- **Day 09** — Mixed problem set
- **Day 10** — Project — design your own mental-math poster

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.